and recycling of nutrients from excreta to create a valuable supply for agriculture. 'EcoSan' toilets are being used in several parts of India and Sri Lanka.

Summary

Degrading natural environments, depleting natural resources, pollution, vulnerability to large scale environmental changes and hazards are the core Environmental issues of today.

Air pollution by fossil fuel burning and other anthropological activities like industrialization is reaching alarming levels and affecting human health and testing the survival of sensitive species.

Domestic and industrial sewage, and agricultural run-off are the most common reasons for pollution of water bodies, resulting in reduced dissolved oxygen and increased Biochemical Oxygen demand of water bodies. Eutrophication and algal blooms are regular occurrences today. Industrial wastewaters are often rich in toxic chemicals, heavy metals and organic compounds which harm living organisms and may even result in death of aquatic life.

Noise pollution is a threat to human and other animals. It can affect health and disturb peaceful habitats. Agrochemicals and its usages cause many ill effects in human beings, other organisms and soil. Agrochemicals can also cause biomagnification. The solution is to revert to non-chemical farming (use of biofertilisers, biopesticides, protect pollinators) practices.

Generation of municipal wastes and their safe disposal are major issues faced by communities today. Solid wastes create environmental problems and must be disposed-off in safe ways. Disposal of solid wastes, radioactive wastes and e-wastes requires further efforts and research. Solid wastes like plastic can be combated by practicing the 4R - refuse, reduce, reuse and recycle. Ecosan toilets are some of the universally accepted eco-friendly practices.

Evaluation

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1. Right to Clean Water is a fundamental right, under the Indian Constitution
   a) Article 12
   b) Article 21
   c) Article 31
   d) Article 41

2. The 'thickness' of Stratospheric Ozone layer is measured in/on:
   a) Sieverts units **b) Dobson units**
   c) Melson units d)Beaufort Scale

3. As per 2017 statistics, the highest per capita emitter of Carbon dioxide in the world is
   a) USA **b) China**
   c) Qatar d) Saudi Arabia

4. The use of microorganism metabolism to remove pollutants such as oil spills in the water bodies is known as
   a) Biomagnification **b) Bioremediation**
   c) Biomethanation d) Bioreduction

5. Which among the following always decreases in a Food chain across tropic levels?
   a) Number b)Accumulated chemicals
   c) Energy d) Force

6. In the E-waste generated by the Mobile Phones, which among the following metal is most abundant?
   a) Copper b) Silver
   c) Palladium d) Gold

7. SMOG is derived from :
   a) Smoke b) Fog
   c) Both A and B d) Only A

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